

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 35

NEW YORK

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside New York's family courts and child-welfare system.

194

NEW YORK FAMILIES ON RECORD · 341 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 14 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 19, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
56 OF 62

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · NEW YORK

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in New York. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Elizabeth Faulkner CONTINUED 1 / 2

ATTORNEY · ULSTER COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Represented the opposing party and, in my experience, advanced false accusations, relied on disputed documents, supported proceedings based on information I believe was inaccurate, and engaged in litigation tactics that I allege contributed to significant financial harm, loss of parenting time, and ongoing due process concerns that are now the subject of my federal civil rights lawsuit. Opposing counsel engaged in a pattern of conduct that interfered with Plaintiff's ability to participate meaningfully in the proceedings, including inconsistent and duplicative financial requests, unilateral communications and decision-making regarding the child, and actions that contributed to Plaintiff's exclusion from key aspects of the child's life. Counsel also submitted and relied upon filings that Plaintiff contends do not accurately reflect the terms placed on the record, while failing to provide access to underlying exhibits and documentation despite repeated requests, thereby limiting Plaintiff's ability to verify the accuracy of the record and respond effectively."*

> *"Liz Faulkner threatened my arrest to force me to surrender custody and support, manipulated court filings and exchange schedules without notice to suspend my child support, made false statements to the court about my daughter's medical care, submitted incomplete records to her providers, and facilitated a coerced $80,000 settlement by threatening that I would be jailed and lose my children. She has lied, changed orders that were signed, tried to extort, manipulate and threaten me with being arrested if I didn't give up custody. She used her sheriff connection to have me arrested for child endangerment. She's filed over 20 petitions and violations against me over a ten year period."*

> *"A judge called her a non-credible witness at trial."* ULSTER

> *"She told my ex-husband that he would receive full custody and pushed the case to trial. At trial, the judge stated that it was a 50/50 custody case and that she would not hear any further argument on the issue. By that time, he had already spent $80,000 on her representation, and not contributing to health insurance for his children."* ULSTER COUNTY, FAMILY COURT

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Elizabeth Faulkner CONTINUED 2 / 2

ATTORNEY · ULSTER COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She's created lies about me for two years so that my ex and I have to keep going back. She does not care about the well being of our children"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-elizabeth-faulkner/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jessica Rachwal

CPS WORKER · ERIE COUNTY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She's lied, she forged documents, she works with foster mom to come up with lies, She coarse me into signing a court menu, she threatens me She lies she ignores the truth. She false lies documents. She doesn't listen to anything that I say and everything she does is almost illegal."*

> *"I was doing a kinship foster for my nieces for her two children, and they violated her due process and then came and took the children out of my house while she was in the process of communication and had no legal stance on it and lied about it"* ERIE COUNTY

> *"She's lied, she has worked to prolong my case with foster families, they continue to violate my parental rights"*

> *"She lies and falsify documents. She coerced children violates parental rights."*

> *"She lies and cohesive children and falsified documents."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-jessica-rachwal/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Kelly Brinkworth

JUDGE · ERIE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She is allowing the CPS attorney to decide basically what happens and there is proof that I wasn't involved and she is allowing them to amend the legion and draft up new ones."*

> *"Refused to hear my evidence. Denied every motion I submitted, including discovery. Was biased and told the father to file for custody. Refused any reunification!"*

> *"She doesn't listen and just follows what CPS says even though they are wrong."* ERIE COUNTY FAMILY COURT

> *"She denied my motion without a hearing"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-kelly-brinkworth/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Adam J. Bello CONTINUED 1 / 2

GOVERNMENT AGENCY · MONROE COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"County executive who sabotaged my business and used a Halloween prop in 2023 to label me a threat to him even though his apex acceleration program was already being bused to my company and his IT ppl were already sabotaging my biz. He has placed his people in my court cases to go against me. He's from Binghamton NY. The attorney referee John Menard approved the first OOP in December of 2023 that had false alienation in it and the two perjurious orders of protection by the mom and fiance on August 29, 2025. Menard use to work at the public defenders office AND is from Binghamton NY. On may 23rd 2024, Darius Lind extended that Meritless OOP for a year. Lind has 3 phone numbers with Binghamton area code 607. Darius Lind's campaign for judge url connected to my second business. Lind has employment background as an IT engineer. Bello's assistant Anthony Figueroa is super shady. He is connected to almost everyone and seems to be the main source to tons of hackers in the area. Bello was a part of an insurance fraud scam on my $209k project with Christa construction. With only two weeks left and $75k profit waiting for me, Christa refused to make a payment to me, then used that insurance being cancelled as a reason to kick my company off of the job site. One of my Angi leads campaigns had a 607 routing phone system where I got no jobs and all customers came up with an excuse. One customer was Jim Whalen. He appears to be related to Gerald Whalen- chief judge of the appellate division in Monroe county. A token identity theft occurred on my new iPhone. The name associated was "Gigi ceravalo". Gail ceravalo is related to Gigi and James Bello. James is Adam's brother. (Some of this may have been spoofed on purpose to make me look crazy. But I have the screenshots and screen"*
> CONTINUES ON THE NEXT CARD

> FAMILY COMMENT CONTINUED
> *"recordings that show proof of everything I've said.)"*

> *"He knows what's taking place and ignores the issues. Doesn't return call or emails. He's no good He knows what is taking place and refuses to respond to emails and calls I've called and emailed and tried to get help and never responds and he knows what's going on and had one of his security guards follow me one day"*

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Adam J. Bello CONTINUED 2 / 2

GOVERNMENT AGENCY · MONROE COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Is nothing but a fraud. Doesn't help out the people and ignored evidence of wrong doing"* MONROE

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-adam-j-bello/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Anthony McGinty

JUDGE · ULSTER COUNTY FAMILY COURT · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"During my year long trial my lawyer and myself begged for reunification therapy for me and my children. Prior to trial I had already been alienated for almost a year. During the entire trial when asked for reunification, he said he would not make any decisions about therapy until all evidence was presented. Following the trial, I waited seven additional months for a trial decision. The decision allowed me to being reunification therapy with my kids."* ULSTER

> *"No due process, advocates and writes his opinion as fact, referred opposing counsel to refer to supreme court and "talk to them" about it!!-avoiding evidence"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-anthony-mcginty/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

John J. Leo

JUDGE · SUFFOLK · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Ignored evidence Yelled in the court room Would not let attorney speak Appointed afc who he has a relationship with Threatened child custody to father Pre judged case before trail Unfair throughout this entire process Screaming yelling throwing hands during court hearings only listening to one side Refusing to let my attorney speak Threatening me with custody of children Pre judging my case before trial"*

> *"Highly erratic and inflammatory judge. Signed off on my divorce."*

> *"Rips families apart for sport Rips children from parents"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-john-j-leo/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Julian Schreibman

JUDGE · ULSTER COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He did not issue a ruling in the divorce trial until nine months after the conclusion of the trial and submission of the case. He also disclosed that he knew the defendant's mother. Although he stated that he would impose penalty fees against my ex for financial abuse and failure to pay day-care expenses, he never did so. Additionally, he did not award either parent final legal decision-making authority, despite the Attorney for the Children stating in her closing argument that the mother should have final decision-making authority because the father was unlikely to follow the recommendations of medical professionals. Throughout the proceedings, he observed my ex hire and fire four attorneys before ultimately representing himself at trial."* ULSTER SUPREME COURT

> *"Vacated my Temporary Order of Protection without a hearing, brought me into contempt proceedings days later, and issued rulings that I believe transferred custody and control to my abuser."* ULSTER COUNTY SUPREME AND FAMILY COURT

> *"Refused to address the inconsistent fraudulent financial information in the divorce record DOMESTIC VIOLENCE AND STALKING NEVER ADDRESSED!"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-julian-schreibman/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Pat Gallagher

JUDGE · MONROE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"If his son is pat gallagher the ada in Monroe county then like father like son! Pat gallagher. Has been maliciously prosecuting me with false charges"*

> *"Judge who appears to be related to the domestic violence leader Patrick Gallagher who was involved in a false narrative on me for domestic violence."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-pat-gallagher/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

RACHEL K. SAELI (Marrero)

ATTORNEY · ERIE · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She goes by 2 names Rachel saeli and Rachel marrero her maden name. Refused to file motions on my behalf. Lied about filing motions. Had multiple exparte communications with opposing counsel. Telling me to shut my mouth about appeal because opposing counsel goes to her for help and she can sway her to our side. Lied on record stating she filed a motion that was never filed. Told me dss attorney goes to her for help so keep my mouth shut and she might be able to get dss to change their minds. Refused to file appeals. Refused to give me documents regarding my case. Spoke with judge many time ex parte while refusing to speak with me."*

> *"ignored evidence Was my first assigned counsel, motioned to withdraw falsely claiming I was not respecting her vacation time"*

> *"Is my current attorney"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-rachel-k-saeli-marrero/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Sarah Rakov

JUDGE · ULSTER COUNTY, FAMILY COURT · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Called my attorney's office and threatened retaliation if my attorney continued to represent me and I did not remove my social media posts, signed an ex parte emergency order removing custody, issued a broad gag order restricting my speech, and later recused herself from the case."* ULSTER COUNTY SUPREME AND FAMILY COURT

> *"Judge Rakov recused herself from the case after Liz Faulkner sent an email accusing her of bias. As a result, we were left without a judge, which delayed the resolution of the case for several months before we were ultimately able to reach a settlement."*

> *"Sarah has denied me due process and has given custody to grandparents with no legal standing."* ULSTER

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ny-sarah-rakov/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

NEW YORK AT A GLANCE.

Across 194 New York families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
341
192 of 194 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$188,050
median across 73 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
14
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
39.2%
76 of 194 who answered; 73 of 193 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
194	1.8	192 of 194	56

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so New York families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF NEW YORK FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	110	$30,000	$95,850	$10,543,500
Lost Wages	93	$20,000	$198,201	$18,432,699
Other Court Fees	54	$2,250	$7,447	$402,114
Therapy / Evaluations	76	$1,100	$7,103	$539,810
Reunification Services	54	$300	$5,529	$298,550
GAL Fees	46	$0	$8,193	$376,865
Asset Loss [1]	79	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (73 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$188,050	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · NEW YORK

Most families documenting in New York are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	105	55%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	22	11%
Not provided	21	11%
Case closed: within last 2 years	17	9%
Active case: progress being made	15	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	93	48%
Family Court Only	83	43%
Unknown	13	7%
CPS Only	4	2%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)	1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	55	29%
5 – 10 years	38	20%
3 – 5 years	38	20%
Over 10 years	22	11%
6 months – 1 year	20	10%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	53	27%
50/50 Joint	46	24%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	44	23%
Full Custody	26	13%
Children in Foster Care	13	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Erie	27	16%
Suffolk	15	9%
Ulster	12	7%
Monroe	6	4%
Richmond	5	3%
Kings	5	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	72	37%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	35	18%
High Conflict Divorce	27	14%
Other	22	11%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	10	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — NEW YORK

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable New York comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *This system has destroyed my relationship with my children as my ex-husband told me he was going to torture me every day for the rest of my life and make sure I had no money to support them other than what I had being disabled in the court allowed false allegation after false [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My kids SA abuse was not handled properly by CPS or investigated properly with the police, and intern it used against myself and my wife. It was said to be a false allegation, even though it came out of the mouth of our children, and they took their therapist. Their therapist [...]

— NEW YORK PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM NEW YORK

The child trafficking industry has ruined my life & my Special needs son landins life our family's life. Idk if we will fully heal from this trauma. We will work on it. As soon as we're allowed to. When landin is home. But until then. U cant heal in forced daily trauma & thats [...]

— JODI

The system is beyond corrupted. It has caused nothing but trauma and devastation to me and the children.

— ANTONINA (ANTONELLA)

Exposed my children to years of abuse and trauma, kept them away from their father for two years based on false allegations by an abusive drug addicted mother. Court didn't care Children lawyer never met with the kids and lied like she did

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Very corrupt and took my family away. Made my kids mental health go down hill and mine to. My kids and husband are begging for me home!!!

— SARAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Here is the revised summary: The Threat and Arrest (2021) One day before a scheduled child support trial, Faulkner called opposing counsel and delivered an ultimatum: give up custody and support, or face arrest. You refused. A family offense petition was filed the next day. Four [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

My biological father is a serial rapist, my mother a drug addict, my step father a felon I left my toxic family to.come to NY for a better life for myself and son. My children are my world! We lost three long years when my daughter was only three years old glued to my hip and we [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has caused unfixable trauma to myself and my children. My 3 yr old has developed a blinking tick. He's had a complete behavioral change, sad crying saying no more daddy house. My one yr old is behind for talking, obsessive sucking of thumb. My 6 yr old foster son who I've had [...]

— MERRISA

My children's father has abused the kids and admittedly uses drugs, has abused and killed family pets, attempted to kill us, stalked me for years and my older children and now has sol custody due to court influences. I (mom) do not smoke, drink, or use drugs, I run an [...]

— NICOLE

They have trauma where trauma wasn't and they have destroyed my life. Make me feel hopeless and in fear for my babies

— MARCUS

It has caused trauma in to children that didn't have any and has broke my heart and my nieces heart

— TESHA

They've caused complete and utter trauma to my children, my family and myself. Broken bonds, broken trust, broken homes. It's completely unfair the power these people hold with just a single false accusation.

— TIANNA

The system has traumatized my children and created more problems than it has ever resolved.

— DUSTIN

Removed my children from me violated my rights to parent.

— SHAWN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *2 petitions back to back with false allegations and a motion with 16 pages of false allegations and a cps report with false allegations and a call to my employer with false allegations....stolen time for my daughter and my relationship*
>
> — JASON

My ex and his attorney submitted false documentation to the court. The judge refused to allow my attorney to speak, while allowed my ex's attorney to speak at length, which set the tone. Marriage was clearly one sided and full of emotional and mental abuse. I am being forced to [...]

— OLIVIA

This system has stripped any hope that a Judge will act and intervene in the best interest of the children from my children and myself. After 10yrs of litigation my children have learned that bad guys win.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destabilizes children and their only stable parent, rips them of life changing money, and exposes the children to acknowledged abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

ACS medically kidnapped my children, shattered our family, and now were being judged by an unjust system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This was a traumatic experience for not only my daughter but myself as well. They ripped my daughter out of the only place she knew as home and placed her with her known abuser and completely dismissed my concerns that he had not changed because he was never mandated to seek any [...]

— RACHEL

The collusion between attorneys has cost me my right to motherhood. It gave my abuser more power.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed my children to be used as pawns because my ex is vindictive and wanted to financially destroy me.

— PAUL

My own attorney enabled legal and financial abuse by working directly with the opposing attorney to prevent me from presenting my medical evidence that showed I was in active treatment for stage 4 metastatic breast cancer, so I was no longer able to work to earn my pre-cancer [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *As an abused women in a 17 yr marriage with one child, I was further abused by the very system I went to for help. I am now an alienated parent, own nothing, and facing jail for contempt after the judge denied my rights (in writing) and refuses to acknowledge my SSI status which [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

I sought help from the family court system to protect myself and my children after years of abuse, but instead we were retraumatized by the very system meant to help us. Years later, we are still recovering from the harm it caused.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allowed the children's mother to Weaponized the system. Use therapist to call CPS. And drain me financially with unjust child support ruling so I cannot access my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court Corruption still exists. Family Court has ripped my youngest 3 children away from their 2 older siblings, myself and all of my family. I've watched all of my children's mental health decline. We are being punished for telling the truth that nobody wants to believe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court placed my now adult twin daughters with a known domestic abuser/sexual predator, leaving them at increased risk of harm, trauma, and poverty. I am being punished with false accusations because I dared speak about my trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It broke me and destroyed my family. I went from being Mom of the year to feeling like a stranger.

— D.

Furthered the abuse and harm we were already facing. When the victims assistance center finally picked us up the night they took us to shelter I remember bawling my eyes out. At that point I had lost hope that there was any real chance at getting out of what we were living [...]

— LEEAH

Ruined it. My kids cry for me, my ex lied, had admitted it and the courts do not care. Lost everything at one point and there is 0 evidence except he said she said.

— AMANDA

Destroyed my family life & friendships. Left me homeless

— ANTONY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *My abuser has been coddled and has been allowed to abuse me through the family court system not just me both my kid's as well.*
>
> — CRYSTAL

Cps has told the school not to release my kids to me on my court order parenting days despite doing everything they asked My ex is also telling my kids the state said there not allowed on my property.

— HEATHER M

Has allowed a child abusing mother that was confirmed by CPS multiple times to continue to abuse and neglect the children to the point of illiteracy. Although court ordered 50/50 custody and every other week visitation I have not seen the children in almost 8 years and I've paid [...]

— WILLIAM

The family court system didn't just drain my savings—it robbed my children of years of stability, holidays, memories, and opportunities that can never be replaced. Instead of addressing high-conflict abuse, the system prolonged it -enabled it, leaving me, a single and hard [...]

— SHELLEY

We have become prisoners in our own lives. We are being trafficked. If I don't say and do everything perfectly, my children can be taken from me in an instant. If I try and make any money they just take it all, making it impossible to have a normal job. My kids and I just want [...]

— FRANCINE

Judge Sandra Munoz is biased and prejudiced against men - especially Christian men. She objects to matters opposing counsel and AFC never raised, denies evidence, withholds parenting time for no good cause, and berates people off the record. Threatened to charge me with contempt [...]

— STELIOS

It ripped my newborn away for 14 months from me and her sisters. All because of one postpartum fluke!

— STEPHANIE

120 New York parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — NEW YORK

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from New York families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> This system has destroyed my relationship with my children as my ex-husband told me he was going to torture me every day for the rest of my life and make sure I had no money to support them other than what I had being disabled in the court allowed false allegation after false allegation to be done along with never giving any sort of financial proof for documentation for years then when he stole them out of my house judge Swick awarded him immediate Child Support out of my disability income, and took my children away from me without any recommendation from CPS or anywhere else just AFC and the judge in her clerk took my kids based on what my ex-husband said
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The child trafficking industry has ruined my life & my Special needs son landins life our family's life. Idk if we will fully heal from this trauma. We will work on it. As soon as we're allowed to. When landin is home. But until then. U cant heal in forced daily trauma & thats what this is. You're grieving daily for your alive child. That's begging to come home. Yet their Captors won't let them. This evil has destroyed my body. From the stress of this case. They took my childhood home. They gave me cancer. Thankfully I cured in time. They forced me to pay for parenting course that they didn't pay me back for. I had to use my ssi money to print out court paperwork. This case cost me A lot of money. That I don't Have the receipts for. I was A victim of an arson fire. That took my childhood Home from me. If this Evil never trafficked my Son. My home wouldn't Have burnt to the ground. This evil took yrs. That I Can't get back with my Son. Milestones that I can't get back. My first born. Only son Currently. Idk if I'll have anymore kids. This evil has Stolen my joy & will to want To live. I live To see my Son returned Home safely & to heal With him. This evil Has made My heart My life Be snuffed Out & turn Black as Cole. I pray when the lord of vengeance comes back & ends this evil for Good & they suffer in hell. Forever. That's my joy. I look forward to.
>
> — JODI

> The system is beyond corrupted. It has caused nothing but trauma and devastation to me and the children.
>
> — ANTONINA (ANTONELLA)

> Exposed my children to years of abuse and trauma, kept them away from their father for two years based on false allegations by an abusive drug addicted mother. Court didn't care Children lawyer never met with the kids and lied like she did
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Very corrupt and took my family away. Made my kids mental health go down hill and mine to. My kids and husband are begging for me home!!!
>
> — SARAH

> Here is the revised summary: The Threat and Arrest (2021) One day before a scheduled child support trial, Faulkner called opposing counsel and delivered an ultimatum: give up custody and support, or face arrest. You refused. A family offense petition was filed the next day. Four days later, a sheriff came to your home and arrested you. Your children were brought to a police station to give statements. A second family offense petition was filed months later on the same allegations. Neither resulted in a finding of violation. Schedule and Support Manipulation Faulkner submitted a document to the court that changed the custody exchange time from 11 a.m. to 4 p.m. without serving it on your attorney. She then used the altered schedule to petition for suspension of your child support, which was granted, based on documentation your attorney never had the chance to challenge. False Statement About Your Daughter In April 2023, Faulkner told the court that a physician had recommended a psychiatric evaluation for your daughter. That statement was false and is directly contradicted by emails from your daughter's treating providers. Incomplete Documentation to Medical Providers Faulkner submitted incomplete documentation to third-party medical providers involved in your children's care, presenting a one-sided record of the proceedings. Coerced Settlement (December 2024) During settlement negotiations, you were told that if you did not pay $80,000, the judge would jail you and you would lose custody. You agreed under duress. The payment went through Faulkner's office. Your attorney witnessed this. Retaliatory Filing (2026) Following domestic incidents in January 2026, during which
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

> your daughter filed a police report and an order of protection was issued, a PINS petition was filed against your daughter. Across eight years, the pattern is the same: criminal threats, manipulated filings, false statements, and financial coercion, all used to pressure you into surrendering rights rather than litigating them on the merits.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My biological father is a serial rapist, my mother a drug addict, my step father a felon I left my toxic family to.come to NY for a better life for myself and son. My children are my world! We lost three long years when my daughter was only three years old glued to my hip and we can never get that back, she had separation anxiety and my son was neglected to the point where he was addicted to electronics as a way to cope. My daughter had nightmares that I wasn't coming back and when I decided to homeschool the foster parents made a false education neglect report AFTER the case was closed for months traumatizing my daughter more when they came to do a wellness check, she hid under the blankets not wanting to talk to them because she didn't want to be taken. We are healing still and the case has been closed for a year and a half.. my children were taken because it is "protocol" to take children from single parents who ask for help and have no childcare. Why did they not call a crisis childcare center like the one in East NY? Doctors get laid 100's of dollars to do what neglect, abandon, abuse, and repeat? Why are lawyers who hate their job allowed to represent parents in ACS cases?? if it wasn't for Mrs. Pollack the new lawyer I wouldve lost my kids to adoption (THEY KEPT THREATENING ME WITH IT) and I wouldve off'd myself. I had to fight like hell to get my sanity back and not give up when a system treated me like a criminal for not seeking different modalities to breath again. Its not ok. There are no signs in the emergency room that says no children allowed or patient only area. If it wasn't for find my mentor Rabbi and converting to Judaism Idk if I would've had the

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

strength to keep finding the joy in our suffering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

My kids SA abuse was not handled properly by CPS or investigated properly with the police, and intern it used against myself and my wife. It was said to be a false allegation, even though it came out of the mouth of our children, and they took their therapist. Their therapist are the ones who hotlined it. They have never gotten justice they fear people who should help them. Their sister was just taking away for the second time with no evidence whatsoever. I've been with my wife for six years. She's been going through this longer, but every day is dreading the next court date.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Has caused unfixable trauma to myself and my children. My 3 yr old has developed a blinking tick. He's had a complete behavioral change, sad crying saying no more daddy house. My one yr old is behind for talking, obsessive sucking of thumb. My 6 yr old foster son who I've had since birth my have been sexually abused and cps refused to take him to the emergency room when he said it hurt up inside him

— MERRISA

My children's father has abused the kids and admittedly uses drugs, has abused and killed family pets, attempted to kill us, stalked me for years and my older children and now has sol custody due to court influences. I (mom) do not smoke, drink, or use drugs, I run an animal.rescue and my own business as well as volunteer time for special.education programs. I homeschool my oldest daughter's who are well rounded and amazing young lady's. I now can't see my children and am constantly being dragged into false allegations court cases and draining any income I have coming in.

— NICOLE

They have trauma where trauma wasn't and they have destroyed my life. Make me feel hopeless and in fear for my babies

— MARCUS

It has caused trauma in to children that didn't have any and has broke my heart and my nieces heart

— TESHA

They've caused complete and utter trauma to my children, my family and myself. Broken bonds, broken trust, broken homes. It's completely unfair the power these people hold with just a single false accusation.

— TIANNA

The system has traumatized my children and created more problems than it has ever resolved.

— DUSTIN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Removed my children from me violated my rights to parent.

— SHAWN

2 petitions back to back with false allegations and a motion with 16 pages of false allegations and a cps report with false allegations and a call to my employer with false allegations....stolen time for my daughter and my relationship

— JASON

My ex and his attorney submitted false documentation to the court. The judge refused to allow my attorney to speak, while allowed my ex's attorney to speak at length, which set the tone. Marriage was clearly one sided and full of emotional and mental abuse. I am being forced to reside NY, although both our families are in MI. He refuses to comply to our agreement and has taken me back to court where we received a new judge who didn't read any of the paperwork and then we were pushed to dismiss our motions. Daughter's attorney has done absolutely nothing to learn about daughter or hear her out. Daughter is now experiencing the brunt of the abuse and therapist, school admin refuse to help her voice be heard.

— OLIVIA

This system has stripped any hope that a Judge will act and intervene in the best interest of the children from my children and myself. After 10yrs of litigation my children have learned that bad guys win.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destabilizes children and their only stable parent, rips them of life changing money, and exposes the children to acknowledged abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

ACS medically kidnapped my children, shattered our family, and now were being judged by an unjust system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This was a traumatic experience for not only my daughter but myself as well. They ripped my daughter out of the only place she knew as home and placed her with her known abuser and completely dismissed my concerns that he had not changed because he was never mandated to seek any help for his abusive behaviors. So not only was this hard on my daughter as it was, but now she had to adjust with the fact that now her dad was trying to turn her against me and push me out of her life. I was also going to school to be a social worker, but being placed on the child abuse registry for leaving my daughter with an adult that I trusted PRIOR TO A COURT ORDER, that stated he wasn't to be with her alone, doesn't make any sense to me. I never realized how much it would affect my life but it still doesn't make any sense to me why I am even on there. No one ever spoke to my boyfriend to even come up with a kind of opinion.

— RACHEL

The collusion between attorneys has cost me my right to motherhood. It gave my abuser more power.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed my children to be used as pawns because my ex is vindictive and wanted to financially destroy me.

— PAUL

My own attorney enabled legal and financial abuse by working directly with the opposing attorney to prevent me from presenting my medical evidence that showed I was in active treatment for stage 4 metastatic breast cancer, so I was no longer able to work to earn my pre-cancer salary. Because of this I ended up having essentially all my SSDI monthly benefits garnished for almost 2 years (putting my children and I way below poverty line), to pay support to my sons father, who has a six figure income and all while we had shared 50/50 custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As an abused women in a 17 yr marriage with one child, I was further abused by the very system I went to for help. I am now an alienated parent, own nothing, and facing jail for contempt after the judge denied my rights (in writing) and refuses to acknowledge my SSI status which is active.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I sought help from the family court system to protect myself and my children after years of abuse, but instead we were retraumatized by the very system meant to help us. Years later, we are still recovering from the harm it caused.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allowed the children's mother to Weaponized the system. Use therapist to call CPS. And drain me financially with unjust child support ruling so I cannot access my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court Corruption still exists. Family Court has ripped my youngest 3 children away from their 2 older siblings, myself and all of my family. I've watched all of my children's mental health decline. We are being punished for telling the truth that nobody wants to believe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court placed my now adult twin daughters with a known domestic abuser/sexual predator, leaving them at increased risk of harm, trauma, and poverty. I am being punished with false accusations because I dared speak about my trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It broke me and destroyed my family. I went from being Mom of the year to feeling like a stranger.

— D.

Furthered the abuse and harm we were already facing. When the victims assistance center finally picked us up the night they took us to shelter I remember bawling my eyes out. At that point I had lost hope that there was any real chance at getting out of what we were living safely. I never imagined it would end up getting me to safety but putting my kids back into harms way and now in a place where I can't even protect them or explain to them what's happening. I can see the confusion and anger in them and it tears my heart open every visit. In my past I did a lot of wrong and my justice was served. Now I'm a good person with lots of wrong being done and no justice. It's a scary place to be but more horrifying place when you can't protect your children.

— LEEAH

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ruined it. My kids cry for me, my ex lied, had admitted it and the courts do not care. Lost everything at one point and there is 0 evidence except he said she said.

— AMANDA

Destroyed my family life & friendships. Left me homeless

— ANTONY

My abuser has been coddled and has been allowed to abuse me through the family court system not just me both my kid's as well.

— CRYSTAL

Cps has told the school not to release my kids to me on my court order parenting days despite doing everything they asked My ex is also telling my kids the state said there not allowed on my property.

— HEATHER M

Has allowed a child abusing mother that was confirmed by CPS multiple times to continue to abuse and neglect the children to the point of illiteracy. Although court ordered 50/50 custody and every other week visitation I have not seen the children in almost 8 years and I've paid close to 25,000 in child support with no access to my children. And you can quote this "every single person named in the aforementioned documents, you know that I have the proof and you know I'm right and what you've done..."

— WILLIAM

The family court system didn't just drain my savings—it robbed my children of years of stability, holidays, memories, and opportunities that can never be replaced. Instead of addressing high-conflict abuse, the system prolonged it -enabled it, leaving me, a single and hard working and capable Mama- financially, emotionally, and psychologically exhausted. I felt ignored, humiliated, and dehumanized by the judge - while the conflict still continues! The judge's behavior is as if she lives to see this fight - by increasing conflict, stress and drama in the courtroom. The greatest loss has been the irreplaceable years of my children's childhood.

— SHELLEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

We have become prisoners in our own lives. We are being trafficked. If I don't say and do everything perfectly, my children can be taken from me in an instant. If I try and make any money they just take it all, making it impossible to have a normal job. My kids and I just want to leave a peaceful life without being controlled and monitored in every direction. They still won't even tell me why we're restricted. 3 psych evals and 2 mental health professionals attest that I am not, nor was I ever, a danger to my children but my ex's attorney says I'm delusional so those professionals mean nothing I guess.

— FRANCINE

Judge Sandra Munoz is biased and prejudiced against men - especially Christian men. She objects to matters opposing counsel and AFC never raised, denies evidence, withholds parenting time for no good cause, and berates people off the record. Threatened to charge me with contempt without valid circumstances, falsely stated I was evasive despite answering all her questions, and effectively made up her mind on how she would rule at trial before it even began. Distorted statements in the PC's report and also took as fact allegations that were blatantly false. Judge Munoz also directed questions to me despite my counselor's presence outside of trial and I stood up as a sign of respect to address her, and she went haywire yelling at me to sit down. Judge Munoz has political appointments and connections and acts as if above ethical judicial standards - despite being not having been recommended by the NYS Bar Association. She is also depicted on social media in pictures with Chief Administrative Judge Joseph Zayas, as well as having reported connections to Gregory Meeks - a Democrat in high political office. I write this now from a hospital bed after she berated me 2 trial dates in a row. She is completely unhinged and corrupt with no concern for truth or justice. Sandra Munoz is dangerous and on a wild power trip.

— STELIOS

It ripped my newborn away for 14 months from me and her sisters. All because of one postpartum fluke!

— STEPHANIE

This court has ruined my children’s future for their own personal gains

— HAL

They have made my other children hate me and are trying to take my child away now they have caused my family to have to live in fear

— MARGARET

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Took my daughter away from me for 30 months when she was only 6 yrs old and she is now 9. A new referee presided over my case and my daughter was finally returned home October 2025, and we are still struggling to repair the damage that family court and CPS has done.

— ALYSSA

I was the only one caring and doing everything for my kids but they were ripped from me and it messed with them tremendously. My 10 yr old did not but cry my 4 yr old almost forgot who I was and I had no bond to my 3 month old.

— KIM

It has broken my family apart, cause immense psychological damage to my children, and forced me to close my business after 34 years

— STEVEN

My family was broken and financially devastated. I will never be able to recover because I am now paying my abuser

— MARK

The system destroyed my family

— SHELBY

Destroyed it completely and utterly. I am homeless, no money to live off of and it has wrecked my side of the family where it will never be what it once was

— JOHN

Mental dostress,severe anxiety, mourning my children who are still alive

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Each and every time my cold and I got abused by my ex, the court would only hear my ex's lies. They never once looked at the abused account of events.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This has ruined my life and my sons and left him with an abuser
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> This lady including many more are stealing children for title iv funding.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Ruined me and my family. I lost everything
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The institutional betrayal of CPS and failures of family Court to protect my child, was far more damaging than the abuse that brought us into the system.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My daughter reported the abuse, and then she placed with her abuser's family.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Family Court allowed court players to fabricate information about me that affected my professional reputation and standing in the community. I have spent thousands of dollars during this ordeal and my children and myself have endured unnecessary emotional trauma.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Medical professionals have failed my daughter. She is living day to day in pain because they are falsely accusing my family, rather than determining the medical issue that she has. The system has ripped apart an innocent family and continues to ignore medical concerns. These children are our universe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They are taking lies as facts so they can fill their own wallets! Evil Corrupt people

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has caused me to lose time with my children and the only thing keeping me alive is my trust in God because I have to trust in the court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severed an established bond between a mother and extended breastfed child who never wanted to leave the mothers side.

— ASHLEY

They injured a child. They threatened her not to tell as she wrote in her diary. She has shut down to everyine.

— JESSICA

The system is corruption every way. No one can understand how this has happened and can only offer prayer. I lost a daughter and my children's sister lost a sister. Grieving a child who is still alive that I can see SOMETIMES.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has destroyed my family when all I was asking for was help. It has cost me my mental health, my children's sense of security, and feeling a loss so big that it hurts us all. It has hurt innocent children and left them with unanswered questions and where their "mom" is.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The court chose a monied party with a lawyer over the best interest of our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Irreversible damage to myself and my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed the few family members relationships due to the lies no help was given when in of loosing 4 of my support people in the year of the nightmare staying busy wasn't good enough one was supposed to stay home 24 7 n tend to invisible kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

False statements to court by ms vesper completely changed outcome of case. Issues ignored and played down showing complete bias by ignoring documents submitted no due process

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Effected my mental health, extreme stress, depression and ruined my relationship with my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Corruption to its rotten core.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

wrongful removal of my children unfounded neglect case

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed me financially and emotionally and broken my trust for the system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Exposed the truth about how corrupt the system can really be.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Not sure yet still in the process but we haven't gotten anywhere and I've spent over $10,000 on an attorney
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system that was meant to protect my children instead replaced their voices with a verdict, separating them from their only advocate and allowing harm to echo where protection should have stood. Protection without accountability is not protection.
>
> — MCKALEA

> They triggered my kids mental health purposely to make her unstable causing a mental health crisis that was turned around on me to take the blame. Lost housing services. My children were groomed into fearing me. loss of $10k in personal belongings that was left behind
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They wanna press charges if my daughter doesn't go again to school because she was threatened by a student there if she near him he will do something bad and she is scared for her life to go back she feels unsafe and she showed the CPS evidence and they didn't care that she still has to go to school if not I will be arrested knowing I'm a good loving single mother God fearing Christian mother raising my kids beautifully and my daughter loves me to much she has a separation anxiety away from me if she leaves or myself leave she cannot go a day without me the CPS are abusing my story my rights and towards my daughter and use it against me for when they wanna put me in court.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have had a major part of who I am torn from me. The system stole my 5 kids. 14 years since I have struggled with this. I've been lost with no purpose. I wish someone would stop them from destroying families just for their gain.
>
> — STACEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system takes a regular break up and allows it to become a dystopian nightmare of child and financial abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has put our lives in danger and added more trauma to what we were dealing with already

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system subjected my family to years of unnecessary conflict, delay, and financial hardship, while enabling my ex to financially abuse both me and our children for years and failing to hold him accountable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Oswego County CVS in family Court is extremely corrupt. They don't care about the kids that really need to help hence why Jordan Brooks and Aaron Max will happen. They pick on people they think they're gonna have a hard time fighting back financially and emotionally. They didn't expect me to get back up every time they knocked me down but every time they did, I dusted myself off and said what do you got now till they finally gave me back my kids not everybody's as lucky as me

— SHAWNA

Made it so I barely get to see my daughter's at all.. two hours a week when they feel like letting me ...

— CHRIS

This system took so much time and the most formative years with my daughter from me. Time neither her or I will ever get back.

— NICOLE

Failed me and said they were doing it as the child's best interest but all I saw was a greedy system with an agenda

— CRISTIAN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed my faith in the system and greatly affected the relationship with my son for no good reason other than for money in someone else's pocket without fair due process

— JESSICA

Obliterated it. They did illegal things, then coerced the mother into becoming a criminal and menace while kidnapping my son under the color of law because they couldn't get him to say he wanted to be with his mom. My son is almost guaranteed at this pinto suffer from long term psychological issues because of losing his primary attachment figure and not seeing them for over 6.5 months straight while being stuck with the mother who was neglecting him on purpose to get a reaction out of me to continue a false narrative.

— WILL

The system claims to be for the best interest of a child but being a child that went through it, sitting in a police station waiting for pick up or being told by a GAL my words weren't my own taught me they didn't care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The NYS family Court System is broken. It is not in the best interest of the child

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The greatest damage was never financial. It was the loss of precious time, memories, trust, and a meaningful parent-child relationship that can never be restored.

— VICTORIA

What happened in family court cost me years with my daughter, drained my finances, and left lasting emotional scars. When a judge's undisclosed connections create questions about impartiality, families like mine are the ones who pay the price!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My daughter lost faith in the system at 10 years old, she's 16 now and I haven't seen her in a year because the attorneys lie about what happened in court and and the court says I am not allowed to discuss what actually happens in court..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has cost me my entire life savings and every expendable penny i have made over the past 6 years. They know good parents will never stop fighting for their children when the other parent is abusive and they exploit that in every measure possible. A protective parent should never be in jeopardy of losing their child to the abuser unless it is PROVEN beyond a doubt that the person intentionally lied.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lost my job. Lost my promotion. About to lose my house. Wife is being guided by the court and is lying about info on the o.p.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a vulnerable adult no one intervened while I stated abuse was happening to me and no one intervened when it continued although my son too was special needs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has done a lot of damage. Financially, mentally and emotionally. My son is not the same. The light is gone in his eyes.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge ignored Domestic violence evidence and arrests. Allowed unsupervised visits, ordered joint custody and forcing me to let him take our child at his leisure.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allow my constitutional rights be violated while allowing an unstable mother have temporary custody amd ignoring all the fact stating wait until trail.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Was never told what allegations were,was drug into court and threatened by my own attorney to give up the children. No paperwork was ever provided until a week after being taken into court. My 18 month old granddaughter nearly died from a broken heart and my 4 year old granddaughter nearly drowned at her foster house from not being watched. She saved herself because we had taught her Early on about swimming and drowning and what to do.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system deprived me of my life, liberty and the persuit of happiness. I never thought I would experience grieving the loss of my children while knowing they're still alive and being abused on a daily basis without being able to heal and live a normal childhood. Going from tucking them in at a night to crying myself to sleep, I am forced to muster up the strength to keep going and I feel as if I'm fighting for my life every single day, this has truly been the most excruciatingly painful thing I could ever imagine, and I would not wish this upon anyone.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

All involved have intentioally caused verbal, emotional, psycological truama by taking extremes measures. My son showing, screaming crying he did not want to go with his father and sleepevers happened with in 2 visits later. His dad was missing for 4 years and Referee didn't tell us about Our Family Wizard until 2024 to coeherse me to sign 50 50 custody. Prior the dad was emailing me and then told to use Whats app where my offender can see my phone number, he would block my calls not pick up. Whenever I put in a motion, petition the father was granted my time without investigating why Chris refused crying and throwing himself on the floor to now go and spoke it too. The police would never let me do reports from drop offs pick up. My offender has a detective cousin. I placed a complaint in 2020 and this shows retaliton towards my son at child care, at school bullying him, teachers never see anything. i'm blocked from doing police reports or electronically played with on obtaining the reports, Police reports not scanned for Judge or Refeee. My son misses me and shows it with school staff, my offender holds the phone and listens, hangs up on me, blocked my calls, didn't answer. Intentional delays, patterns of retaliation, my attorneys not doing their jobs, forcing me to all forms of investiagation. Even tho, my offender and his sister has shown aggression at police stations and protected by the law because I can not get and order of protection against her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This happened to me 16 to 17 years ago I don't remember much, I reconnected with my son once he turned 13

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The antiquated family court system is one of my initiatives for running for House of Representatives. I know god has handled my cases but I know that god appears to be missing from many.
>
> — JESSICA

> Just existing IS exhausting... I hide in my basement I don't go anywhere I don't have friends I don't have a job unfortunately just existing is all I can handle right now
>
> — MARGARITA

> I've learned it's not Justice, it's "JUST US!"
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has separated us with no cause and we have been lost/ignored in the system for almost two years.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The family court system used fraud and bullying tactics to separate me for my children where I was a primary custodial caretaker for 3 1/2 years. They did this in an effort to solely get my ex-wife child support and payments, regardless of the fact that her situation was significantly worse for the children as their actual care was never considered.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has failed myself and my two daughters, and has enabled my ex to continue her atrocious behavior and alienation tactics that are hurting our daughters and severely damaging their relationship with me. It’s truly disgusting!
>
> — RYAN

> When a loving sole custody parent looses physical custody from an discharge to noncustodial parent at Erie County Hospital to be DARVO Railroaded through Erie Family Court
>
> — AMY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Jacqueline Bashkoff should not be allowed to provide forensics anymore. She disregarded evidence, failed to contact collaterals, and put forward a deeply flawed report that was damaging to everyone involved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children's IQs have dropped significantly as a result. I have been pathologized, insulted, humiliated, by court "professionals", and I have been financially buried. The case has been unnecessarily drawn out for years. Court actors are more concerned with filling their pockets through abusing their power and control, rather than their jobs, which is to look at, review evidence, uphold the constitution and laws appropriately, and to put all children's needs at the forefront, instead of profiting off children's pain and suffering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system took a father from his child, ignored evidence that didn't fit the narrative, and rewarded allegations that were never properly proven. The greatest cost wasn't financial—it was the years of a parent-child relationship that can never be returned.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Don't trust anyone and keep you feelings to youself don't ask for help they twist everything around them and your always wrong it's sick that the government swore to protect us is hurting more for there personal pockets not what's right by law

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"This system has wrongfully interfered with my life, reputation and family, targeting me through coordinated actions while placing my daughter, Tynylah, connected to Talicia Craig, in harm's way and beyond my protection."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court leveraged my child to financially drain me until I was forced into bankruptcy. I was then told I could not afford the defense to protect my daughter so I had to sign an unfavorable agreement or risk losing my parenting time.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> The system has taken over 25 years the bond between a mother and her child time loss of the connection loss of special events holidays , birthdays graduation ceremonies Mother's Day and soso much more to meany to write down
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Ruined me in my child
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system didn't just separate me from my child—it accelerated my documented disability, pushed me into emotional crisis, and left me fighting for stability while being denied basic information about my own son." "After nearly two years of barriers, delays, and unanswered requests, the damage has extended beyond the courtroom, affecting my mental health, my finances, my housing stability, and my ability to maintain a meaningful parent-child relationship."
>
> — WILLIAM

> Parental Alienation is real.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system failed to do the one thing it was supposed to do: protect my child. I lost my home, my life in America, and years with my son, and now I am facing an arrest warrant after a court ordered my daughter into the custody of a man who is the subject of an INTERPOL Red Notice relating to pedophilia-related crimes.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system took a straightforward divorce seeking equal custody and, through a pattern of exclusion, obstruction, and imbalance, deprived me and my child of meaningful time, stability, and our fundamental parent-child relationship. It fractured not only our bond, but also our connection to extended family and critical life milestones during irreplaceable years.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

120 full approved New York comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this New York report comes from New York respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in New York — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 194 New York families reporting here are not the universe of New York families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

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Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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